

SMT Macro Bias Framework

3-Timeframe Confluence Ladder · v1.0 · June 2026

Overview

Before engaging any 1-minute scanner signal, the macro bias must be confirmed across three timeframes in sequence: 15-minute, 5-minute, and 1-minute. Each layer must agree with the intended trade direction. A conflict at any layer is grounds for cancellation.

Step 1 — 15-Minute Structure Read

Zoom out to the 15-minute chart and identify the current market state. This is the anchor for all downstream decisions.

Identify one of four conditions:

- Bullish trend — higher highs, higher lows, structural breaks to the upside
- Bearish trend — lower highs, lower lows, structural breaks to the downside
- Ranging — price oscillating within a defined high/low tunnel
- Trend losing momentum — structure still intact but displacement between breaks is shrinking

Also note on the 15-minute:

- Whether the current bullish/bearish move has already fully played out before your session
- Whether price is at the top or bottom of a larger range (reduce confidence in continuation)
- Swing marker tool may mark structural points one bar off on 15m — account for this when reading SMT

Note: If the macro move has already played out (e.g. a bullish push completed hours ago), do not assume continuation. Reassess what the market is likely to do next, not what it just did.

Step 2 — 15-Minute SMT Check

With the structural bias established, look for an SMT on the 15-minute chart that confirms or conflicts with that bias.

- Bullish 15m SMT in a bullish structure = strong confirmation, proceed to Step 3
- Bearish 15m SMT in a bearish structure = strong confirmation, proceed to Step 3
- Opposing 15m SMT = warning flag — weaken bias or step aside entirely
- No 15m SMT present = acceptable, rely on structure read alone, proceed with caution

Example: 15m shows bearish structure. A bearish 15m SMT between two structural highs confirms the directional bias. A bullish 15m SMT forming at the same time is a conflict — cancel.

Step 3 — 5-Minute SMT Check

Drop to the 5-minute chart and look for an SMT that aligns with the 15m read. This is the mid-tier confirmation layer.

- 5m SMT in the same direction as 15m bias = confluence confirmed, proceed to Step 4
- Opposing 5m SMT = cancel the trade, even if the 1m signal and macro bias are correct
- No 5m SMT = acceptable if 15m is strong, proceed with reduced conviction

Note: A 'loose' 5m SMT (e.g. equal highs on one instrument where the swing marker didn't tag it, but the structural point is visually clear) still counts as valid context. Use discretion — if it looks like a structural point, treat it as one.

Step 4 — 1-Minute Entry (Scanner Signal)

Only after Steps 1-3 are aligned do you engage the 1-minute scanner signal. The 1m SMT + FVG setup is the entry trigger, not the analysis.

- Wait for a valid 1m SMT (both points swing-marker tagged, wick-to-wick, same timestamp)
- Wait for a displacement FVG to form after the SMT in the reversal direction
- Place limit order at the 50% midpoint of the FVG
- SL: beyond the structural swept level
- TP: fixed 3R

If the 1m SMT fires but there is no FVG — no entry, no exceptions.

Cancellation Rules

Cancel any signal if any of the following are true:

- **Opposing SMT on the 5-minute — cancel regardless of macro or 1m signal**
- **Opposing SMT on the 15-minute — cancel**
- **Ranging market with no directional SMT on any higher timeframe — stay out**
- **The macro move has already fully played out before the session — reassess**
- **Against-macro trade direction — cancel, no exceptions**
- **Conflicted macro (15m and 5m disagree) — treat same as against-macro**
- **No FVG formed after the 1m SMT — no entry**
- **FVG not interior to structure — skip**
- **Signal outside session hours or within 30-minute session cutoff — skip**

Quick Reference

Timeframe	What to Look For	Conflict = Action
15-minute	Trend state + SMT in bias direction	Opposing SMT → cancel
5-minute	SMT confirming 15m direction	Opposing SMT → cancel

1-minute	SMT + FVG entry signal (scanner)	No FVG → no entry
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Derived from manual review of Dec 2025 – Feb 2026 scanner signals. Framework reflects observed edge from 3-timeframe SMT confluence. For use alongside scanner v8.1 output.